

Cost per task, not cost per token

ONE APPROVED COMMENTARY · ILLUSTRATIVE

Token cost

one draft at list prices

≈ US\$0.11

With regenerations

× 2.5 drafts, plus judge calls

≈ US\$0.30 well under a dollar

Reviewer time

the real cost driver

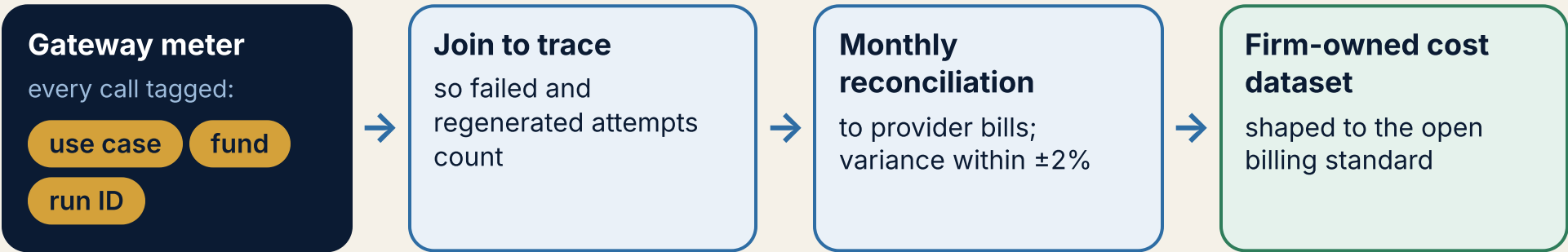
much larger: not to scale

THE SIGNAL TO REPORT

Cost per approved output, alongside the regeneration rate

counting every failed and regenerated draft; a cheaper token that needs three retries and a longer review is not cheaper

HOW IT IS MEASURED



BUDGETS NEED TEETH

"A budget without a quota is a number, not a control"

FinOps Foundation. Pair every cap with an enforcement point that fails closed, so a runaway agent loop stops itself.

WORKED EXAMPLE · STEP 2

L1 C6 L2 C1 L3 C2 L4 C4 L5 Reg L6 C7 L7 C5 L8 C3 L9 C8

Illustrative arithmetic for one approved monthly fund commentary at list prices: tokens come to well under a dollar, and reviewer time is the real cost. Reviewer bar not to scale. Generic: no vendor names.

Veyan · the view at end of Q3 2026
Source: C6 §C6.3, §C6.9 and §C6.12